

How Much Does a Kitchen Remodel Cost in 2026? Complete Price Guide

Meta Title: Kitchen Remodel Cost 2026: \$15K-\$75K Breakdown by Project Type Meta Description: Kitchen remodel costs in 2026 range from \$15,000 to \$75,000+. See exact price breakdowns by project size, materials, and region.

Thinking about remodeling your kitchen? Here's what you'll actually pay in 2026—broken down by project type, materials, and location.

Kitchen Remodel Cost Summary

Remodel Type	Cost Range	Per Sq Ft
Minor refresh	\$15,000 - \$25,000	\$75 - \$125
Mid-range update	\$25,000 - \$50,000	\$125 - \$200
Major renovation	\$50,000 - \$75,000	\$200 - \$300
High-end/custom	\$75,000 - \$150,000 +	\$300 - \$500 +

National average (2026): \$35,000 - \$45,000 for a 150 sq ft kitchen

Cost Breakdown by Category

Here's where your kitchen remodel dollars actually go:

Cabinets: 25-35% of Budget

Cabinet Type	Cost Range	Notes
Stock (prefab)	\$3,000 - \$8,000	Limited sizes/styles
Semi-custom	\$8,000 - \$18,000	More options
Custom	\$18,000 - \$40,000 +	Any size, any style

Pro tip: Cabinet refacing (\$4,000 - \$9,000) saves 30-50% vs. replacement if your boxes are solid.

Countertops: 10-15% of Budget

Material	Cost per Sq Ft (installed)
Laminate	\$25 - \$50
Butcher block	\$55 - \$100
Quartz	\$75 - \$150

Mountain (Denver, Phoenix)	1.0 - 1.1x	\$40,000 - \$44,000
Midwest (Chicago, Minneapolis)	0.95 - 1.05x	\$38,000 - \$42,000
South (Atlanta, Dallas, Miami)	0.9 - 1.0x	\$36,000 - \$40,000
Rural areas	0.8 - 0.9x	\$32,000 - \$36,000

Kitchen Remodel ROI

Will you get your money back? Here's what the data shows:

Remodel Type	Average Cost	Resale Value Added	ROI
Minor kitchen remodel	\$27,000	\$22,000	81%
Major kitchen remodel (mid-range)	\$45,000	\$32,000	71%
Major kitchen remodel (upscale)	\$85,000	\$50,000	59%

Source: Remodeling Magazine Cost vs. Value Report 2026

Key insight: Modest, well-executed remodels recoup more than over-the-top renovations.

Sample Kitchen Remodel Quotes

Example 1: Minor Refresh (\$18,500)

- Cabinet refacing: \$5,500
- New countertops (quartz): \$4,200
- New faucet and sink: \$800
- Backsplash (subway tile): \$1,800
- Painting: \$1,200
- New lighting: \$1,500
- Hardware: \$500
- Labor: \$3,000

Example 2: Mid-Range Renovation (\$42,000)

- Semi-custom cabinets: \$14,000
- Quartz countertops: \$5,500
- Appliance package: \$8,000
- LVP flooring: \$2,400
- Electrical updates: \$2,500
- Plumbing updates: \$1,800
- Backsplash (tile): \$2,200
- Painting: \$1,400
- Permits: \$600
- General contractor: \$3,600

Example 3: High-End Remodel (\$78,000)

- Custom cabinets: \$28,000
 - Quartzite countertops: \$9,500
 - High-end appliances: \$18,000
 - Hardwood flooring: \$4,800
 - Electrical (new circuits, lighting): \$4,500
 - Plumbing (relocate sink): \$3,500
 - Designer backsplash: \$3,800
 - Professional design: \$2,500
 - Permits: \$900
 - Project management: \$2,500
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Red Flags in Kitchen Remodel Quotes

Watch for these warning signs:

- ✗ **No itemized breakdown** — Every quote should show materials, labor, permits separately
 - ✗ **"Allowances" for everything** — Vague allowances hide pricing until you're committed
 - ✗ **No permit mention** — Kitchen remodels often require electrical/plumbing permits
 - ✗ **50%+ deposit required** — Standard is 10-30% down, remainder in milestones
 - ✗ **Way below market rates** — If it's 40% cheaper than everyone else, ask why
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How to Get the Best Price

1. **Get 3-5 quotes** — Same scope, same materials specified
 2. **Time it right** — Winter (Jan-Feb) is slow season; contractors negotiate more
 3. **Bundle projects** — Doing bathroom too? Package deals save money
 4. **Keep the layout** — Moving plumbing/electric adds \$5,000-15,000
 5. **Choose stock cabinets** — Custom adds 50-100% cost for marginal benefit
 6. **Verify every quote** — Use tools like Ungouge.ai to catch overcharges
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Is Your Kitchen Quote Fair?

Got a quote in hand? Here's how to check it:

✓ **Materials are itemized** with specific products and quantities ✓ **Labor is broken out** by trade with estimated hours ✓ **Total falls within regional ranges** shown above ✓ **No mystery line items** or unexplained lump sums ✓ **Permits included** if required

Still unsure? [Upload your quote to Ungouge.ai](#) for a line-by-line analysis against current market rates. \$19.99 could save you thousands on a \$40,000 project.

FAQs

How long does a kitchen remodel take?

- Minor refresh: 2-4 weeks
- Mid-range renovation: 6-10 weeks
- Major remodel: 10-16 weeks

Should I get a permit?

If you're doing electrical, plumbing, or structural work—yes. Always.

Can I live in my house during the remodel?

Usually yes, but expect 1-2 weeks of no kitchen access. Plan for takeout.

How much should I budget for overruns?

Add 10-20% contingency to any kitchen budget. Surprises happen.

Last updated: February 2026 Data sources: KBIS 2026, RSMeans 2026, Remodeling Magazine Cost vs. Value 2026